

PRIOR AUTHORIZATION REQUIREMENTS

SilverShield Health Plans | Plan Year 2025 | All Plan Tiers

Prior authorization (PA) is a requirement that your physician or other health care provider obtain approval from SilverShield before prescribing a specific medication or providing a specific service. This process helps ensure you receive the most appropriate care. When prior authorization is required, your provider must contact SilverShield before providing the service. If prior authorization is not obtained, claims may be denied.

To request prior authorization: Call Provider Services at 1-800-555-0400 | Fax clinical documentation to 1-800-555-0401 | Submit online at silvershieldhealthplans.com/providers/priorauth

INPATIENT HOSPITAL SERVICES

Service / Procedure	CPT / Code	Auth Required?	Clinical Criteria Summary	Turnaround Time
Non-emergency inpatient admission (all facilities)	All admission codes	YES	Medical necessity documentation; physician attestation; alternative outpatient options considered	2 business days
Inpatient psychiatric admission	All psych admission codes	YES	Acute safety risk; outpatient/IOP level of care not sufficient; suicide risk assessment required	24 hours
Inpatient rehabilitation admission	All rehab admission codes	YES	3 hours/day therapy capacity; post-acute need; prior hospitalization within 30 days	2 business days
Skilled Nursing Facility (SNF) admission	All SNF admission codes	YES	Requires prior 3-day hospital stay; skilled nursing need documented; daily skilled care required	2 business days
Long-term acute care (LTAC)	All LTAC codes	YES	Complex medical condition requiring extended acute care; ICU-level care ≥ 25 days	3 business days

OUTPATIENT SURGICAL PROCEDURES

Service / Procedure	CPT / Code	Auth Required?	Clinical Criteria Summary	Turnaround Time
Bariatric surgery (sleeve gastrectomy)	43775	YES	BMI ≥ 40 or ≥ 35 with comorbidity; 6-month supervised diet program; psych eval; no substance abuse 2 years	5 business days
Bariatric surgery (gastric bypass)	43644, 43645	YES	Same as sleeve gastrectomy; primary surgery failed or contraindicated	5 business days
Spinal surgery (cervical fusion)	22551, 22554	YES	Conservative therapy ≥ 6 weeks failed; radiculopathy confirmed on MRI; neurologic deficit present	3 business days
Spinal surgery (lumbar fusion)	22612, 22630	YES	Conservative therapy ≥ 3 months failed; instability or deformity on imaging; functional limitation documented	3 business days
Total knee arthroplasty	27447	YES	Conservative therapy ≥ 3 months; radiographic confirmation severe OA; BMI < 40 preferred (BMI ≥ 40 requires additional review)	3 business days
Total hip arthroplasty	27130	YES	Conservative therapy ≥ 3 months; radiographic OA Grade III/IV; functional impairment documented	3 business days

Service / Procedure	CPT / Code	Auth Req uired?	Clinical Criteria Summary	Turnarou nd Time
Shoulder arthroplasty	23472	YES	Conservative therapy $\geq$ 6 weeks; rotator cuff integrity confirmed or addressed; imaging confirms joint destruction	3 business days
Cardiac catheterization (diagnostic)	93454–93461	YES	Positive stress test or high-risk clinical features; non-invasive imaging inconclusive	2 business days
Percutaneous coronary intervention (PCI)	92920, 92928, 92933	YES	Significant CAD on catheterization; symptoms despite optimal medical therapy or acute coronary syndrome	Urgent: 24 hrs
Hysterectomy (laparoscopic)	58570–58573	YES	Fibroids, endometriosis, or cancer confirmed; conservative treatment failed or contraindicated	3 business days
Gender-affirming surgery	All gender-affirming surgical codes	YES	ICD-10 F64.0; 12 months hormone therapy (if medically appropriate); mental health clearance; 2 letters from qualified providers	5 business days

ADVANCED IMAGING

Service / Procedure	CPT / Code	Auth Req uired?	Clinical Criteria Summary	Turnarou nd Time
MRI – Brain	70553	YES	Unexplained neurological symptoms; prior CT inconclusive; headache with red flag features	1 business day
MRI – Spine (any level)	72141, 72148, 72156	YES	Radiculopathy/myelopathy unresponsive to 4-6 weeks conservative care; new neurological deficit; cancer/infection suspicion	1 business day
MRI – Knee	73721	YES	Internal derangement suspected; conservative care $\geq$ 4 weeks failed; unexplained locking/instability	1 business day
MRI – Shoulder	73221	YES	Rotator cuff pathology suspected; conservative care $\geq$ 4 weeks; clinical examination inconclusive	1 business day
CT – Abdomen/Pelvis	74177, 74178	YES	Acute abdominal pain with clinical red flags; abnormal lab findings; or oncologic staging	1 business day
PET Scan	78816	YES	Oncologic staging, restaging, or treatment response; biopsy-confirmed malignancy or strong clinical suspicion	2 business days
DEXA Scan (Bone Density)	77080	NO (once per 2 years)	Women $\geq$ 65 or men $\geq$ 70; younger with risk factors. No PA required for standard screening frequency.	N/A

SPECIALTY DRUGS & HIGH-COST MEDICATIONS

Drug Category	Examples	Auth Req uired?	Clinical Criteria Summary	Turnarou nd Time
Biologic agents (TNF inhibitors)	Adalimumab, Etanercept, Infliximab	YES	Confirmed RA, PsA, AS, or Crohn's; Step therapy: 2 conventional DMARDs failed ($\geq$ 3 months each); TB test negative	3 business days
Biologic agents (IL inhibitors)	Secukinumab, Ixekizumab, Ustekinumab	YES	Confirmed moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis or PsA; step therapy: topical therapy and methotrexate failed	3 business days

Drug Category	Examples	Auth Req uired?	Clinical Criteria Summary	Turnarou nd Time
GLP-1 receptor agonists (obesity)	Semaglutide (Wegovy), Tirzepatide (Zepbound)	YES	BMI ≥ 30 or ≥ 27 with comorbidity; 3-month lifestyle intervention documented; no prior bariatric surgery	3 business days
GLP-1 receptor agonists (diabetes)	Semaglutide (Ozempic), Dulaglutide	YES	Type 2 diabetes confirmed; HbA1c $\geq 7.5\%$ on metformin; CV risk documentation for Ozempic	2 business days
PCSK9 inhibitors	Evolocumab (Repatha), Alirocumab (Praluent)	YES	LDL ≥ 190 mg/dL or FH confirmed; statin at maximum tolerated dose ≥ 3 months; LDL still ≥ 100 mg/dL	3 business days
Specialty oncology agents	All oral/injectable oncology drugs	YES	Pathology-confirmed malignancy; oncologist attestation; FDA-approved indication or NCCN Category 1/2A	24 hours (oncology)
Multiple sclerosis DMTs	Natalizumab, Ocrelizumab, Ofatumumab	YES	MS confirmed by McDonald criteria; baseline MRI; neurologist attestation; no active hepatitis B (natalizumab)	3 business days
Growth hormone	Somatropin (all brands)	YES	GH deficiency confirmed by stimulation test; pediatric: height < 2 SD; adult: pituitary pathology documented	5 business days

HOME HEALTH AND DME

Service / Procedure	CPT / Code	Auth Req uired?	Clinical Criteria Summary	Turnarou nd Time
Home health care visits	G0151–G0162, T1030	YES (> 20 visits)	Homebound status documented; skilled nursing or therapy need; physician-ordered plan of care	2 business days
Private duty nursing	T1000, T1001	YES	Medically complex condition requiring continuous skilled nursing; not manageable with intermittent visits	3 business days
CPAP / BiPAP device	E0601, E0470, E0471	YES	AHI ≥ 5 confirmed by sleep study; symptomatic OSA documented by sleep physician	2 business days
Enteral nutrition (tube feeding)	B4150–B4162	YES	Cannot meet nutrition needs orally; medical condition preventing adequate oral intake; physician attestation	2 business days
Infusion therapy (home)	All home infusion codes	YES	IV antibiotic, IVIG, or other infusion; stable to receive at home; trained caregiver present	2 business days
Power wheelchair	K0835–K0843	YES	Unable to self-propel manual chair; upper extremity limitations; cannot ambulate household distances safely	5 business days

DISCLAIMER: This is synthetic data created for training purposes only. All CPT codes, criteria, turnaround times, and drug names are illustrative and do not represent actual clinical criteria or insurance policy terms.